

The Cost of Carrying *Invisible* Things

Four short exercises to find the loop running in your background, see who it's leaking onto, and take one small step toward putting it down.

NAME

DATE

LOOP AGE

1 Find the Loop That's Running in the Background

- Name **one unresolved thing** you keep replaying — the exact moment, where you were, what was said.
- Skip resolution with the other person. What ending could you write for *yourself*?
- Rate it **1–10**: how much bandwidth is this loop eating on an average day?
- Name one task this week the *fog* hit — reread paragraph, forgotten thing, forty minutes gone.

LOOP DETAILS

2 Trace Where the Weight Leaks Out

- Pick someone close. Where has **shortened patience** or quiet distance shown up with them lately?
- Has anyone said "*you're here but not really here*"? Write it as close to word-for-word as you remember.
- What are you protecting them from by staying silent — is it working, or costing the relationship instead?
- Pick one person kept at a remove. Write **one true sentence** for them this week that isn't "I'm fine."

WHO + WHAT LEAKED

3 Do the Cost Accounting

- List **three things** you're carrying silently right now — just name them, no explaining.
- For each: how long carried — a week, a year, longer?
- Compare *cost of containment* vs. *cost of naming it to one person*. Which is really higher?
- If your brain's pool is finite, what's **one thing you'd get back** — creative, professional, relational — if this closed?

THE THREE THINGS

4 Choose One Small Act of Unloading

- Pick the **lightest** of your three things — not the heaviest. Who's one safe person to tell this week?
- Draft the *first sentence* you'd say out loud, exactly as you'd say it.
- What's the smallest version of "not fine" you could admit to someone today?
- Set a **specific day and time** for that conversation. Put it somewhere you'll see it.

PERSON + MOMENT